

ICT SKILLS - II

09

Managing Files and Folders

A systematic guide to understanding computer file systems, organizing digital data, and performing essential file operations.

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Class 10th C

Why File Management Matters



The Wardrobe Analogy

Storing information on a computer is like organizing clothes in a wardrobe. Placing clothes systematically in separate drawers saves time and energy, whereas throwing everything into one drawer causes chaos and delay.



The Computer File System

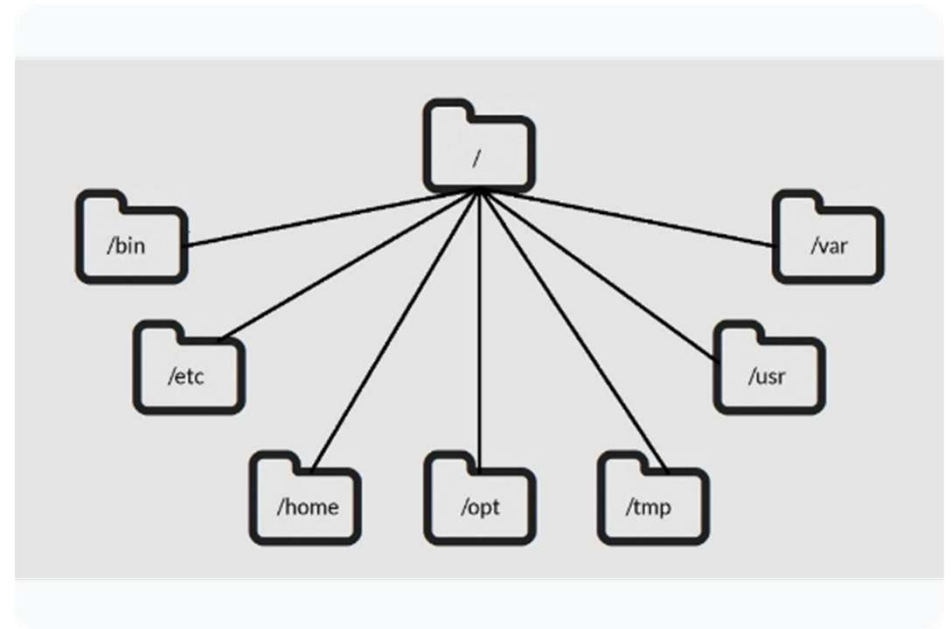
If files are saved randomly on a computer, finding them later wastes significant effort. The Operating System provides a **File System** to logically organize and name data for effortless storage and retrieval.

Understanding the File System

Hierarchical File Architecture

The File System is a layer of system software responsible for organizing and managing stored data. Most OS (Windows, macOS, Unix) use a tree-like hierarchy:

-  **Root Folder:** The topmost directory containing all other elements.
-  **Folders (Directories):** Organizational containers used to group related files.
-  **Sub-folders:** Folders nested inside other folders to create refined levels.



Creating Files and Folders



1. Context Menu

Right-click once on any blank area of the Desktop or inside File Explorer to open the shortcut context menu.



2. Choose 'New'

Hover over **New** and select **Folder** or choose a file type (MS Word, Excel, Text Document, etc.).



3. Name & Confirm

Type a descriptive name for your new item at the cursor location and press the **Enter** key to save.

Renaming Files and Folders



Context Menu Method: Right-click on the file/folder, select **Rename** from the menu, type the new name, and press Enter.



This PC Ribbon Method: Open [This PC](#), select the item, and click the **Rename** button located in the [Organize](#) group under the Home tab.



Keyboard Shortcut: Select any file or folder and press the F2 key to quickly edit its name.



Pro Tip - Batch Renaming: Select multiple files at once, choose rename, and type a single name. Windows will automatically append sequential numbers, e.g., [Project \(1\)](#), [Project \(2\)](#).

Deleting Files and Folders

Quick Deletion Methods

To remove unwanted items from your computer:



Select the file/folder and press the Delete key.



Right-click the item and choose **Delete**.



Use **This PC** → Home Tab → *Organize Group* → **Delete**.

Two Deletion Options

When deleting an item, you can choose:



Recycle: Moves the item to the Recycle Bin so it can be safely restored later if needed.



Permanently Delete: Erases the file completely from the computer disk (Shift + Delete).

Recycle Bin Operations



Restore Single Item

Open Recycle Bin, select the item, and click **Restore the selected items** under Recycle Bin Tools tab to return it to its original location.



Restore All Items

Click **Restore all items** on the top ribbon toolbar to instantly retrieve all deleted files back to their previous folder paths.



Empty Recycle Bin

Right-click the Recycle Bin icon on the desktop and click **Empty Recycle Bin** to permanently remove all items and free up hard disk space.

Moving vs. Copying Data



Moving a File / Folder

Moving shifts the file from its original location (source) to a new location (destination). The file is completely removed from the original place.



Copying a File / Folder

Copying creates an exact duplicate copy of the selected file or folder in the destination folder, while keeping the original intact at the source.

Methods to Move and Copy



Ribbon Toolbar Method: Open [This PC](#), choose your file, and click **Move to** or **Copy to** from the [Organize group](#) on the Home tab. Choose the destination path.



Context Menu Method: Right-click the file and select **Cut** (to move) or **Copy** (to duplicate). Navigate to the target folder, right-click blank space, and choose **Paste**.



Keyboard Shortcut Method: Select file → Press Ctrl + X (Move) or Ctrl + C (Copy) → Go to target location → Press Ctrl + V (Paste).

Essential Shortcuts Summary

Action	Shortcut / Method	Result
Rename Item	F2 or Right-Click → Rename	Edits the current file/folder label
Move Item	Ctrl + X then Ctrl + V	Relocates item (Cut & Paste)
Copy Item	Ctrl + C then Ctrl + V	Creates a duplicate copy
Temporary Delete	Delete key	Sends item to Recycle Bin
Permanent Delete	Shift + Delete	Bypasses Recycle Bin completely

Key Best Practices

100%

Organized Digital Workspace

Golden Rules for File Storage

Following structured file management ensures smooth workflow and reliable storage:

- ✓ Always use clear, meaningful folder names (e.g., *Math_Homework_2026*).
- ✓ Group related files inside sub-folders to maintain logical hierarchy.
- ✓ Periodically empty your Recycle Bin to clear system storage.

SESSION COMPLETE

Questions & Review

Thank you for participating! You now master the fundamentals of managing files and folders effectively.

Unit 3: Information and Communication Technology Skills-II

Image Sources

 Thumbnail for <https://www.linuxtrainingacademy.com/wp-content/uploads/2014/03/linux-folders.jpg>
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